

NYC Labor Market Snapshot: August 2026

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Independent Analysis of New York City employment trends using BLS Current Employment Statistics data and R.

At a Glance

- 4.85 million total nonfarm jobs
- +0.9% year-over-year (U.S.: +0.3%)
- +219,000 jobs vs August 2019

What We're Seeing

- **Momentum is back:** NYC added about 44,600 jobs from August 2025 to August 2026 jobs, a 0.9% gain that outpaces national growth of 0.3%. Growth has been positive since April 2026 after six months of year over year declines.
- **Recovery is concentrated:** Employment is 4.7% above 2019, slightly behind the U.S. at 5.2%. Education and Health Services added about 226,000 jobs since 2019(+22.2%), more than the city's entire net gain. The other five sectors studied are roughly flat combined.
- **Sector divergence:** Financial Activities (+31,600) and Professional and Business Services (+18,500) remain above 2019 levels. Leisure and Hospitality (-25,800), Mining, Logging, Construction (-24,300), and Information (-8,100) have not recovered, with Leisure and Hospitality is still shrinking (-2.4% year over year).
- **The Late 2025 dip partly reflects changes in home care:** NYC Employment growth fell -0.9% year over year in March 2026, alongside weakness in Education and Health Services. The slowdown coincided with New York State's April 2025 transition of the Consumer Directed Personal Assistance Program (CDPAP) to a single discal intermediary, which affected reported home-health employment; contemporaneous analysis also points to possible worker reclassification across related social-assistance categories. Because these changes began in spring 2025, their effect on year-over-year comparisons began rolling out of data in spring 2026.
- **NYC vs U.S.:** NYC grew far faster than the nation in 2022, converged through mid 2025, fell below it in late 2025, and has pulled ahead again in 2026.

Figure1. NYC Employment Growth Has Recently Moved Back Above the U.S.

Year-over-year change in total nonfarm employment, %

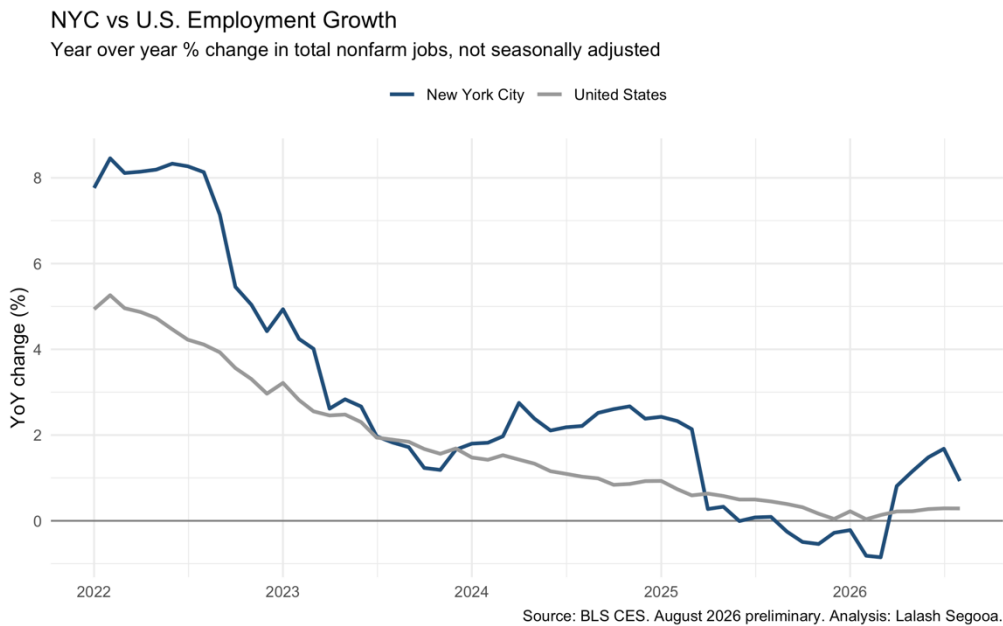


Figure 2. Education and Health Services Has Driven NYC’s Post-Pandemic Job Gains

Change in employment by selected supersector, August 2019 – August 2026, thousands

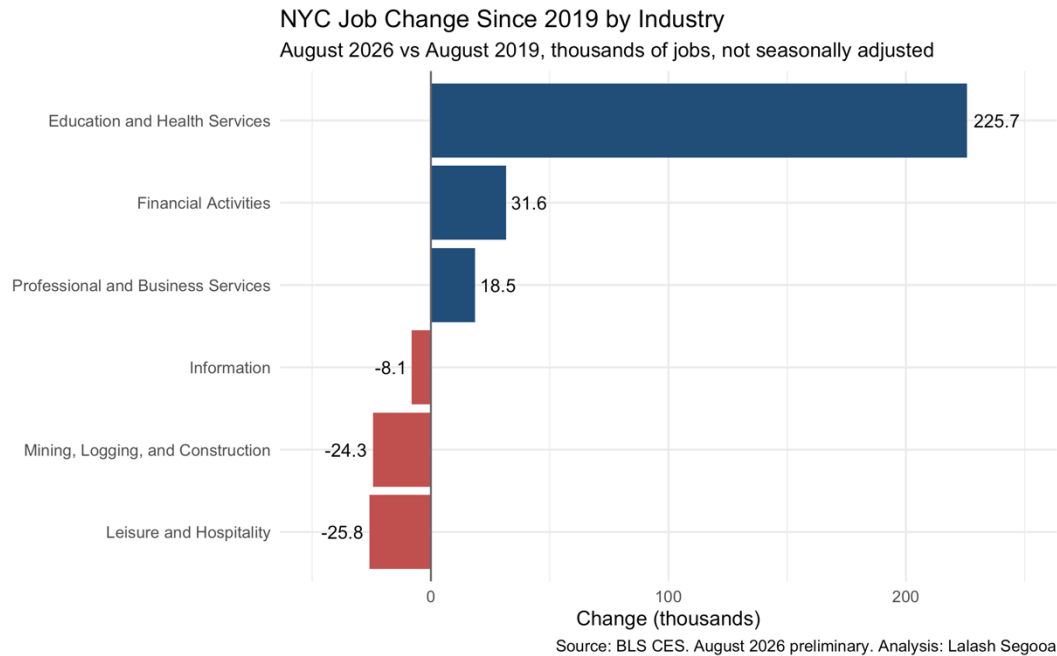
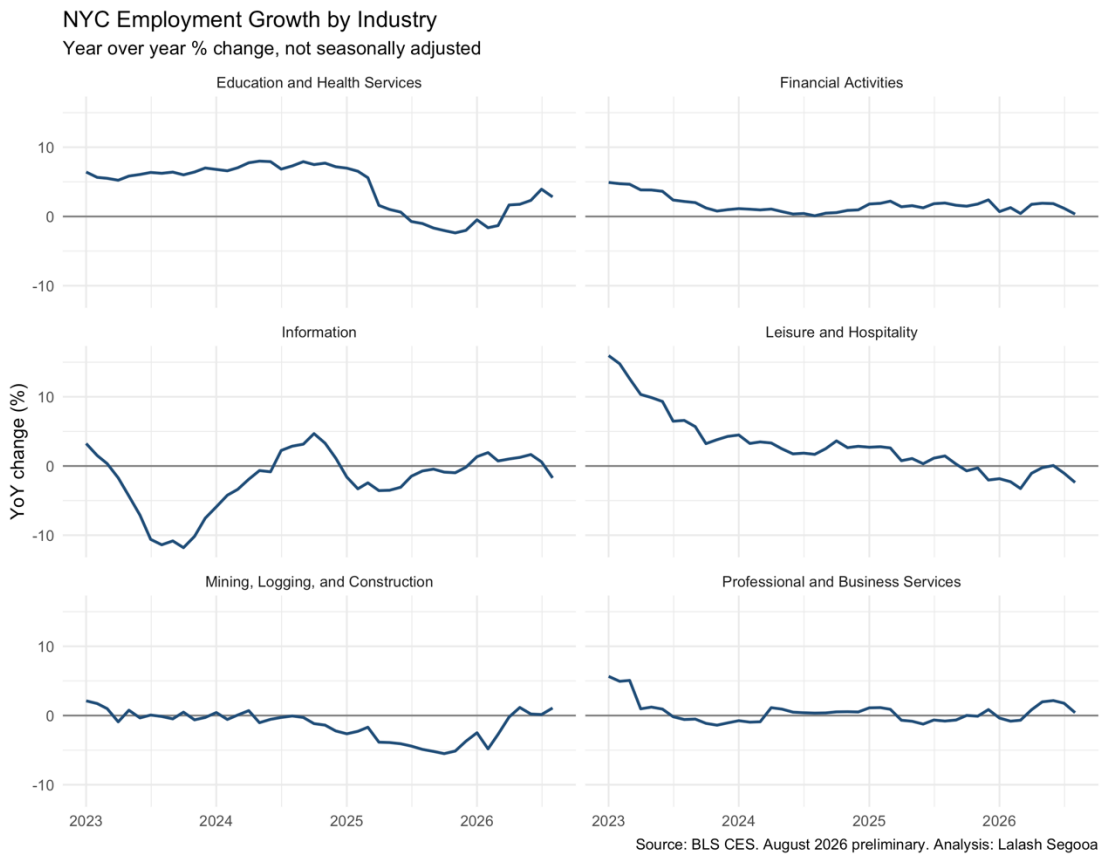


Figure 3. Recent Employment Growth Has Recently Moved Back Above the U.S.

Year-over-year change in total nonfarm employment, %



Methodology:

BLS Current Employment Statistics, not seasonally adjusted. To control for seasonal patterns, each month is compared to the same month from the year prior. **August 2026 figures are preliminary and subject to revision; all earlier months reflect published estimates.** Data downloaded September 28-30, 2026.

Analysis and charts by Lalash Segooa (R).